

The First Impasse Is Falling Out of Prayer

Let us take our first step. First Corinthians 12:1 reads this way:

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

If there is any area the Church is ignorant in, it would be concerning spiritual gifts. He says, "Concerning these spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant."

You know as well as I do that He would not make a statement like that, entering into a chapter, without going on before the chapter is over and supplying all the information you and I need to eradicate spiritual ignorance.

Knowing these things caused me to pitch a tent in this chapter, drive the stakes deep, camp there, and meditate and meditate until I finally began, at least, to emerge with an understanding of His spiritual empowerment, not only in the gifts and in the offices, and not only in the nine gifts empowering the offices, but in the eight operations of God.

I meditated until my meditator liked to fall out on the ground. I got my interlinears, outer linears, interiors, exteriors, Wuest, Strong's, and added any assistance I could to eradicating my spiritual ignorance.

I moved into a tent and camped in that chapter time after time. I hid the whole thing in the midst of my heart so I could meditate on it day and night. I cannot study day and night. I cannot memorize day and night. I cannot read day and night. But I can meditate day and night because I devoured that chapter, stored it in the midst of my spirit, and can pull it out any time I want, day or night, lapse over into meditation, and listen to the Holy Ghost over and over.

Why? Because I know He is the only One who can bring me out on the other side of it walking in power.

I found out this power has everything to do with peace.

I have meditated, and do you know what I found out? I do not have five weeks, so I am going to skip some things. I found out there are nine gifts of the Spirit. Of course, that is lying around on the surface.

Jesus said the man who does His sayings is the man who can weather any storm, because he dug deep and laid his foundation on the rock of doing His sayings. If the rock is doing His sayings, then the deep digging was into revelation knowledge to lay that house on the rock. That means the things He is talking about are not lying around on top of the ground. Dig deep.

I found out there are nine gifts of the Spirit. Of course, I am not telling you anything you do not know. I also found out that these nine gifts of the Spirit are in divine order. He starts with the word of wisdom and ends with the interpretation of tongues: word of wisdom, word of knowledge,

faith, gifts of healing, workings of miracles, and so on. They are all in divine order.

That made me finally understand why dinosaur kind of ministries like Lester Sumrall bulldoze everything in front of them. With Lester, you have two options: join him or get out of the way. Your choice. The man continues to build layer after layer upon the foundational rock his life is established on, and nobody seems to be able to stop him. The man's ministry is saturated with the word of wisdom. That word of wisdom is the top. It is a priority gift of the Spirit.

These nine gifts of the Spirit empower the five ministry offices. They not only empower; they qualify. We know more about them as faith people than almost anything else: apostle, prophet, evangelist, pastor, teacher.

These nine gifts not only empower but qualify what constitutes an office to be an office. It is the power of the Holy Spirit flowing through that office. If all you want to do is teach, then you are a teacher. If all you want to do is pastor, then you are a pastor. If all Jesus in you wants to do is apostle things, then you are an apostle. If all Jesus wants to do in you is prophet people, then you could be weird.

The nine gifts empower and qualify the five ministry-gift offices. These nine gifts that empower these five offices are enveloped in eight operations of God, and these eight operations constitute the makeup of the entire body of Christ.

You fit somewhere within the barriers of these eight operations of God. I do not care who you are, your background, or where you come from. If you are born again, you are called to fill one of these eight operations.

Look at 1 Corinthians 12:27:

Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.

You and I are individual members in a vast body called the body of Christ.

Notice that miracles and gifts of healings have replaced the pastor and the evangelist because by this time they are qualified as operations of God. These two power gifts, miracles and gifts of healings, envelop and empower the pastor and evangelist offices. That is what qualifies them.

Then the sixth operation is helps, the seventh is governments, and the eighth is diversities of tongues.

It is a shame, because until we find out more about this eighth operation, we are not going to know very much about the other seven operations.

Paul says:

Are all apostles?

God forbid, no.

Are all prophets?

Heaven's sake, no, even though most think they are.

Are all teachers?

Depending on the sleeping rate during services, I would say no.

Are all workers of miracles?

Of course not.

Have all the gifts of healing?

Of course not. Everybody's office is not empowered by gifts of healings, although everyone is called to lay hands on the sick and see them recover. There is a difference.

Then Paul says something I almost wish he had left out:

Do all speak with tongues?

I beg your pardon.

I felt like counseling Paul. "You could have made it a whole lot easier on guys like me if you had left that statement out."

Have you almost had a Baptist cornered, just about to get him, and he says, "Wait a minute. I remember a verse." He flips over and looks at you: "Do all speak with tongues? No more do all speak with tongues than all are apostles and prophets and teachers."

For a long time, I just hoped they would not find that verse while I had them cornered. I sure did not know what to say.

Then he says:

Do all interpret?

The reason he called that eighth operation diverse tongues is that the word "diverse" means diversities, different manifestations of the supernatural language called tongues. The reason the Church has gotten into such problems over this eighth operation is that we have tried to clump the

exact same set of rules onto all the different diversities of tongues, and we have come up with mass confusion.

It is impossible.

Right here I am going to tell you something: there has never been an operation of the Spirit the devil is more afraid of, because there has never been a gift quite designed like this one to get involved with your personal life.

If the devil could not remove it from generation to generation like he did through the Dark Ages, then he mass-confused it so badly that it was discredited and any person of integrity would not want anything to do with it.

What is it about this lowly gift, this eighth operation, that strikes such fear in Satan's heart? Why does he fight it so hard? Why is there an entire chapter dedicated to understanding the proper use of this eighth operation if it is not one of the most dangerous things you can get your hands on?

If he could not remove it out of the Church, he discredited it by confusing everyone.

The last thing on God's green earth the devil wants is for you to blunder onto it, like I did. I would like to take credit for it, but I cannot. I blundered onto it. I only started praying with tongues to survive the hours I had committed to, not because I had any great, astounding, deep revelation.

What is it about this gift that strikes such fear into the devil?

I wish I could fill the office of an apostle five minutes after I am born again. I cannot. No more than the prophet, the teacher, workings of miracles, or gifts of healings constituting the evangelist's and pastor's office. It takes years of maturing, seasoning, training, and finally separation by the power of the Holy Spirit.

I cannot even fill helps and governments five minutes after I am born again. That is what church splits are made out of.

"Oh, you have a lot of money. Let me put you on my board. Come on, you little flesh creature. Just keep making those large donations and you can have a vote as one of our counselors."

"My, my, you have a voice like Elvis Presley. You can really move people. I have room on my staff for you."

All the time, because there is no character development and no seasoning of the Holy Spirit, there are character flaws lurking just beneath the surface, waiting to leap up on your operation and tear it up.

I cannot even fill the ministries of helps and governments five minutes after I am born again, because a man must be found and proven faithful.

But there is one operation, and that is the eighth, that I can not only fill five minutes after I am born again, but I can fill it simultaneously with my rebirth. I actually enter into the government of God on the level of the eighth operation.

When I am born again, counselors get hold of me and say, "Have you spoken in tongues since you believed?"

"Tongues? What is tongues?"

"Trust me, little lamb of God. In a moment your mouth will be shaping supernatural words."

"What supernatural words?"

"Do you remember during the evening you heard a couple of people go, 'So lo ko she me son bo...'?"

"Yes, I have been meaning to ask you about that."

"Well, you are about to do that, you little sheepy sheep. Glory to God."

"Whatever you say. I do not know anything about it. Who did you say Jesus was?"

"He is the Son of God. He is the One you just received. But now this One is the Holy Ghost. You are going to get Him next."

"Whatever you say. I guess it is okay with me."

Then you start speaking. You are literally filling an operation of God called diversities of tongues simultaneously with the rebirth, because it is your supernatural entry into the government of God.

Hallelujah.

The reason he calls it diversities of tongues is that there are four different supernatural manifestations of this eighth operation.

The first is tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift. Tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift.

The second diversity, the second supernatural manifestation of this eighth operation, is tongues for interpretation, for use in a public assembly.

The third diversity is tongues that extend themselves into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit and literally empower a saint. This is what happens when there is a catastrophe about to take place or a group of people that little mothers have been begging God to save. All of a sudden, in the Spirit, you come to a place in your life where you qualify, and God literally reaches down in this third diversity, picks you up by the nap of your neck, and sets you down on a pathway between hell and people trying to get there.

He just puts you there.

This third diversity empowers the believer in deep intercessional groanings, literally empowering you to stand in the gap for your family, your church, your city, and your nation. You can cause revival in a nation before your God. It is as powerful as the workings of miracles. If you are honored by God to slide into that supernatural gift from time to time, the results will be just as powerful, forthcoming, and immediate as the workings of miracles.

The fourth diversity is tongues that present themselves in a public assembly as a sign to the unbeliever. That gift as a sign to the unbeliever simply comes upon you, transcends your intellect, and empowers you to preach, teach, or testify in any language you had no previous knowledge of. That, my friend, is a sign to the unbeliever personified.

I wish I could operate in that sign to the unbeliever anytime I wanted to, but I cannot. That one is severely as God wills. How do you know? Because I have tried.

"Hello, foreigner, how are you doing?"

He says, "Translator?"

I said, "Never mind."

It has happened to me nine times, but I did not choose the time. I cannot do that anytime I want. No more than I can slide into the deep intercessional groanings anytime I choose. My God, I wish I could. I would deliver this city to you in a month. But I cannot.

I have known plenty of people who have tried. They were classified as a little weird.

"What time is it? Intercession begins in one minute. Five, four, three, two, one, zero." They estimate about an hour has passed. Really, it has only been forty-five minutes, so they poke a fellow groaner: "You have fifteen more minutes."

Nothing ever comes of it. The back door of the church does not get plugged; it gets wider.

I cannot operate in the deep intercessionals anytime I want. I cannot even operate in tongues for interpretation anytime I want, or else why would he say, "If any man speak in tongues, let him pray that he may interpret"? Why pray about it if I could do it anytime I wanted?

How do you know you cannot? Because of that dreadful silence. Sometimes false interpreters will go ahead and try to bail you out anyway.

You say, "What am I doing?"

He says, "Causing confusion and edifying yourself."

There is only one diversity I can operate in anytime I want, just because I want to, as long as I want to. That is one-fourth of the diversities of tongues: tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift.

I can operate in that one as much as I want, as long as I want. In fact, if I let Him go, He will pray the next thirty days. I am the one who has to stop it.

"I will stop now."

He says, "All right."

"I will start now."

"All right."

Have you ever noticed how servant the Holy Spirit is in that area?

That is the only gift of the Spirit I can operate in anytime I please. All the rest of them, words of wisdom, word of knowledge, intercession, interpretation of tongues, tongues as a sign to the unbeliever, discerning of spirits, all of them operate severally as He wills, and flow through you for the edification of others.

There is only one gift in the whole makeup, in the whole eight operations, that is designed to flow to you for your own edification, and that is tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift.

He has done with this gift what He has done with no other. He has made you the steward of its operation because He has made you the steward of your own edification.

Hallelujah.

Go to Mark 4. The Holy Ghost is letting me go.

God has done with tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift, what He has done with no other gift. He has made me the steward of its operation. I can edify myself as much as I want, as long as I want, just because I want to.

I have been to camp meeting after camp meeting, and I have instilled into people what has been inside me. But it was not until He purged me to peace and brought me into a place in His holiest of holies that I had not been in before, and really did not even imagine was possible, that I could see more clearly.

Until that point, I instilled into every person who would listen to me, camp meeting after camp meeting, what God commissioned me to instill into them:

Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

The only thing I really knew how to do was get people excited enough to turn their personal lives over to some degree of prayer.

As the love of God grew in me, you cannot know how it would break my heart. I would get people so excited over prayer. I would come back to camp meetings year after year, and out of that hundred or hundred and fifty people who got so excited that they had finally found out there was a way to draw nigh to God on purpose, just because they wanted to, they would tuck those ten-pound Bibles under their arms and march for the prayer closet.

In that first month or so, you had better stay out of their way.

"I am going to intercession. I am going to pray. Get out of my way."

You did not dare try to stop them because they would march right over the top of you. I would be so excited to leave people in that condition. But a year later I would come back and ask, "Where are those hundred devil-stomping, mountain-moving intercessors with those ten-pound Bibles who were marching on the devil when we left?"

"Oh, after about a month or two, fifty or sixty dropped off. In the next three or four months, we lost another thirty or so. Some lasted almost five months. Then it finally settled back down to the same four who were hanging around praying in the first place."

You cannot know how this affected me.

One day I was across the street in Tulsa, and the Holy Spirit spoke up just as loud in me and said, "I want you to stop long enough. Come off the field for a certain amount every week to establish within these people the ability to pray."

He called it enduring prayer.

He said, "I will teach you things during this time about prayer that you do not know. You have experienced them, but you have never been able to put words to them."

So we settled down with a bunch of people and began to walk them through prayer. I wanted to know why people fell out of prayer, why intercessors are labeled weird, why they have the reputations they have, why they cause so much trouble, why there is war in the teacher's camp against the intercessors' camp.

What is going on? How can a person pray for three months and then either get weird or fall out of prayer?

The teachers came on the scene to mop up the mess and made great, astounding statements like, "Well, you can pray in tongues too much." How would they know? Another said, "It opens you up to God, but it also opens you up to the devil."

My, how can you edify yourself too much?

I was with Rick Renner after he finished teaching one night. I went back to the tape table with him, and this person stepped up and said, "I think God has called me to be an intercessor. But I know this woman, and God called her to be an intercessor too, and I think she prayed too much because she started getting weird. How do I keep from getting weird?"

I finally could not take it anymore. I stepped up between him and Rick, faced the man, and said, "If you get weird, it is because you already had a capacity to be weird."

I could not take it anymore.

In these four diversities of tongues, there are four power flows that will eventually manifest in the lives of people who learn enduring prayer.

Two of the diversities are designed for public assemblies: tongues for interpretation and tongues as a sign to the unbeliever. Two are designed to empower the believer in the prayer closet: tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift, and tongues that eventually extend into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit.

When a man learns enduring prayer, four power flows envelop themselves in these two diversities that empower a believer in the prayer closet.

The first power flow is tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift. This is when you can walk back and forth hour after hour and pray in tongues. It does not matter if you scream it and think you are warring. It does not matter if you think you are screaming at the devil until the veins pop out in your neck.

"Do you hear that, devil?"

No, he did not hear it, because you are just edifying yourself.

Tongues for personal edification is the number one power flow. That one is the revelation gift. It will sustain you through most of your enduring prayer. It is the one you will live in most of the time when you are in God's presence in prayer, because you will be free-flowing.

We just love it when the Holy Ghost pulls things out of our lives that we want to get rid of. Why do we love that? "I did not like that ugly thing that kept me from getting healed. One day I was praying in the Holy Ghost, and God revealed that ugly thing that was keeping me from getting healed. I mortified it. I cut it off, and then I got healed."

We love it when He reveals things we want to get rid of, things keeping us from drawing closer to God. When we do not like it is when He reveals things we do not want to get rid of. And He does that.

I have stayed in motels where you come in after a meeting and look for the light switch on the wall, but it is a string somewhere in the middle of the room. At least they have electricity. Bathroom down the hall. Telephone down the street.

You come in after a meeting looking for the light switch, walking across the room fanning the air, when all of a sudden you hear, "Crunch. Crunch." That was a big one. You pull the light, and all these little creatures of darkness, cockroaches, run for the cover of darkness, except for the trail of dead bodies.

You look over at the counter, and there is a big rat glaring at you with a whole cat tail hanging out of his mouth. This guy is big. Then a cockroach comes out from behind the rat. Does it not make you mad when you turn the lights on and there is always that cockroach that just stands there and licks his hands like, "I am in no hurry. I am going to finish this meal."

So the deal is on. You get your faithful can of Raid out. You spray him, and he rallies. He runs into his little hole and comes out with boxing trunks and gloves on. He says, "You want to fight, buddy? I am not running from you anymore."

Most of us have character flaws. When the Holy Ghost came and baptized some of you, He stood up, looked around at His new home, and said, "My God, it is a good thing I am God. Short of Me, I do not know who could help this person."

He surveys all of these cockroaches hiding in the corners of darkness and says, "It is a good thing I came because I am God, and I am going to start praying for this person. They do need My prayers."

The first thing He does is free-flow. He edifies and edifies through tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift, until you start being full of mysteries, divine secrets, revelation, and understanding of everything Christ is in you, the hope of glory, turning inside your spirit as long as you let Him.

God begins to pray for you. Divine secrets and mysteries are transferred between your spirit and God's Spirit. When He answers scripture you have never understood, wisdom you have never had, divine secrets you have had no understanding of, these things ignite and begin to burn with fervor inside a believer who learns enduring prayer.

There is just one problem: all these cockroaches are hidden in little rooms of darkness. You pray every day, and the illumination keeps creeping higher and higher in your life. Every day you hear screams as these cockroaches say, "Oh, you got me." Another one has been dragged into the light, exposed, and put to death.

Finally the kingpin, the big cockroach of self-exaltation, is up in the royal suite at the top. He hears the screams of his comrades as edification empties every room. Finally the light begins to flash across his room, and little rays of sunlight hit his carpet.

He says, "I am not running."

He goes into his closet, gets his boxing gloves and trunks, marches right into the center of the light, and says, "I am not running anymore."

All right, cockroach of self-exaltation, how are you going to stop the edification going on?

He says, "I am going to declare war on this anesthetized, twentieth-century, computerized mind. I am going to deliver blow after blow of emotions you never dreamed possible. I will not give up my position of High Lord Self-Exaltation. I will not."

All of a sudden, you have been free-flowing and doing fine. Little cockroaches have died all along the way. "I just love this church. I am here for the duration. I will be as faithful as flypaper. I am stuck on you. You can count on me."

Three or four months go by. Five months go by. The Holy Spirit has been able to bring you to a place in edification you have never been before. You are not going to spend four, five, or six months in prayer and come out worse for it. It is a spiritual impossibility.

You will not spend five months in mysteries and divine secrets being transferred from His Spirit to yours and not change. But you have chosen to enter into the holiest of holies of self-exaltation, the cockroach of the love of money, the cockroach of strife and hurt, the cockroach of molestation that left scars so deep you have not survived it, the cockroach of rape that scarred you so badly you lie there at night, the cockroach of abortion from the old days, whom the devil condemned you with until revelation knowledge came and you realized you took an eternal life of God, and it is forgiven and you need to know that.

That cockroach of self-exaltation marches into the middle of the light and declares war on your anesthetized, computerized mind.

When he does, all of a sudden your free flow changes. Emotions begin to hit your words, splat. So you go to the kitchen and get a spatula. Every tongue you pray is just collecting on the floor.

"I do not feel like praying. In fact, I came and spent an hour in intercession, so I tend to believe what that teacher told me is true. You can spend too much time praying in tongues. People get weird from praying in tongues."

If you get weird, it is because you already had a capacity to be weird. All you did was bring out something you were already capable of, my friend, and it took you out of prayer last year.

So you start hitting this impasse. This cockroach of self-exaltation says, "Watch this," and punches with his right hand. The more you pray, the more that self-exaltation is exposed. "I do not want to give this up. I have had this prestige. I have used this. I have thrown my weight around. I have used my money in the church. I have bought my exaltation. I do not want to give it up. You think I am going to be a lost number in the body? You think I am going to be one of those little people? I have had this position too long. I am not giving it up."

The more you pray, the more depressed you feel.

"I thought praying in tongues was supposed to edify you. Instead I left depressed."

At six or seven months, it hit the prayer center. All these cockroaches living in people, things that had taken them out of prayer and made them weird before, started surfacing. People started going home. We would track them down and say, "Are you not coming back to pray anymore?"

"I do not want to pray. No, I am not coming back to pray. And I will tell you something else: I do not even want to want to pray."

Let me give you a little hint. Although free flow is fun, when you hit that second power flow, that is what has been sealing your life last year. Those are the things that exist in you that the devil could use anytime he wanted to control you with.

You hit this ceiling, and all of a sudden you do not feel like you are getting through. The heavens feel brass. Your emotions are fighting. You want to retain the integrity of the old man, and the Holy Spirit wants to put him to death. An emotional war takes place. The more you pray, the more depressed you feel about it.

Folks, on the other hand, you are actually producing more power to stay in when you hit that impasse than you are when you are free-flowing. I know when I hit that, there would be somebody free-flowing next to me, and I am going, "The heavens are brass. It does not feel like I am getting through."

Quite the contrary, you are getting through. Those emotions took you out last year, so why are you going to trust them? They are the ones that messed you up before, and you are trusting them now. Tell them to shut up.

You are producing more power than you were free-flowing. Free-flowing brought you to that place. He brings these things out at that point because you are never in better spiritual shape to put them to death than after spending four or five months in free-flowing edification, divine secrets, illumination, mysteries, and the igniting of the Word.

You are never in better shape, and the Holy Ghost will choose that time, when you are ready, to pull those emotions out and let you put them to death. You are entering into a mild form of intercession for yourself. That is not the time to give up. That is the time to stay in.

You are now producing more power than you produced in the four months before, because now He is putting to death the things that sealed your life and kept one year like the next until five years down the road you look back and your life has not changed.

Hallelujah.

I can hardly wait until we get into the deep groanings, the intercessional part this week, because this is where He is heading you for more. He wants to make you something God can pick up and drop on a pathway between hell and people trying to get there, just because you are available and because there are no character flaws the devil can move in and destroy you with for producing enough power to get a city born again.

Makes me want to pray more. I think I will. See you guys later.

Let us look at these verses for a moment. I do not want to overload you tonight. Are you learning anything?

Mark 4:18:

And these are they which are sown among thorns...

The thorns already existed.

...such as hear the word,

And the cares of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entering in, choke the word, and it becometh unfruitful.

And these are they which are sown on good ground; such as hear the word, and receive it, and bring forth fruit, some thirtyfold, some sixty, and some an hundred.

Then He said:

Is a candle brought to be put under a bushel, or under a bed? and not to be set on a candlestick?

The subject is those sown on good ground. The subject is the Word of God producing in our life up to a hundredfold.

Is the Word of God given to you not to understand? The Word of God is given to you for the same reason a man walks into a room, puts a candle on the table, and ignites it. Every obstacle hidden in darkness in that room suddenly has light shined on it.

Is the Word given to you not to understand? Is a candle brought into a dark room not to ignite? The subject is the Word. Is the Word given to you not to understand?

Then He went on to say something incredible:

For there is nothing hid, which shall not be manifested; neither was any thing kept secret, but that it should come abroad.

If any man have ears to hear, let him hear.

The subject of this is the sower sows the Word. He is asking you a question: is the Word given to you not to understand, or is it given to ignite your spirit the same way a candle ignites a dark room? When you enter the dark room, every obstacle hidden in darkness is suddenly brought to light.

I would be lying to you if I told you I did not want to produce a hundredfold of these eight operations. I do not yet know my final resting place in these eight operations: apostle, prophet, teacher, worker of miracles, gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities. I do not yet know my final resting place.

But I do know this: whatever it is, I want to fill my operation wall to wall.

If I were a businessman, I would want to be responsible for multi-billions of dollars flowing to the kingdom from my hands. I would pick gladiators, champions of the truth, and I would pay their mouth literal millions of dollars to represent my portion of the kingdom and sweep millions into the gospel. I would do it because He would give me the ability to do it.

He is promising me here that the Word is given to ignite. The Word is given to you to make good ground that produces a hundredfold. He says there is nothing hidden that will not be made manifest, nothing kept secret that will not be brought to light.

What is it in your life that is keeping you from producing a hundredfold? Have you got a cockroach?

He gave you a guarantee: there is nothing hidden that will not be made manifest. Anything keeping you from receiving a hundredfold, He will pull that thing out for full inspection in the revelation knowledge of His light.

This is why praying in tongues, the number one power flow, is a revelation gift. During that free flow, divine secrets and mysteries are transferred from your spirit to God's Spirit and from God's Spirit to yours. The mysteries you are flowing in are the same ones that have been hidden in God since before the foundation of the world. They are all the mystery, wisdom, and understanding of everything Christ is in you, to you, and through you, the hope of glory.

When somebody preaches to you, that is the candle of the Word. When you pray in tongues, my friend, you ignite it. Every verse hidden in you since Sunday school days, when you pray in tongues, you are praying the mystery, the understanding in that verse, up before the Father. When He answers that prayer, it ignites that verse, and the brilliance of the light that arrays in every direction starts dragging those cockroaches out, those things hidden in darkness that keep you from receiving a hundredfold.

My friend, not all of them want to die.

When our prayer center hit cockroach time, people got mad at the stupidest things.

Have you ever noticed that when God is exposing your problem, you pick on everybody else? All of a sudden, as their own character flaws and weaknesses were dragged into the light, especially the ones of self-exaltation they did not want to get rid of, these intercessors started coming in and things like this took place:

"I am not coming here anymore. Look at this dingy orange carpet. It is not worthy of myself. And I do not like the music."

This side got to hating that side, and that side hated this side. Intercessors who thought they were something would come in and say, "We could win the whole city for God. We could do it if you would just get out of my chair. You know I always sit in that chair."

Oh my God. My chair. Stupid.

This side wanted me to go discipline that side, and that side wanted me to go discipline this side. "Would you go discipline them? Do you know what they did to me?"

I would say, "Pat, pat, pat. Get back in prayer." Then this side would say something, and I would say, "Pat, pat, pat. Get back in prayer."

They wanted me to run over using extreme discipline and tie them up.

Let me tell you what that is equivalent to. If you tie a man up in a chair to keep him from sinning, you might as well turn him loose, because when you turn him loose, he is going to sin.

"Why do you have that man tied up?"

"Because every time I untie him, he sins. I want him to live holy."

He is sitting there all tied up, saying, "You may have my body tied up, but I am sinning on the inside."

You might as well untie him, because he is guilty.

You can force this person to go apologize. "No, I have to." "Why?" "What will I lose if I do not?"

"Your job. Your paycheck." Since the discipline you have inflicted on me is worse than not doing it,

"I am sorry. Are you happy now?"

No. You did not do anything.

It is the same with the man whose problem is women. He says, "I need to be delivered." What are you going to do, put him on an island where there are none?

We are always wanting God to change everything around us when He is trying to change the problem. He said He would make a way to escape, and we think the way to escape is when we close our eyes and pray and He changes everything around us.

God forbid that I am the one who needs to be changed.

So they wanted me to tie this bunch up to make them be nice to that bunch. That would not do any good, because as soon as you untie them, they go over and get ugly again.

So what did you do, Roberson? I got the whip and said, "Look, the things you people are doing now are what existed on the inside of you. Quit blaming each other. You have hit an impasse. If you will stay in, you will come through it. Get on your knees and pray, pal."

"But we know you are wrong too."

"Back in prayer."

The most incredible things began to happen. Those things began to die. Now those same people look back and say, "I am so embarrassed. Do you mean to tell me I was capable of that stuff?"

I mean to tell you that you were capable of that stuff. But now that it has died, the ceiling is off your life. The devil has no more handles to control you with or knock you out of prayer.

He is going to make an intercessor out of you yet. Stay in there. Your life is changing. You are conforming to Him. All your handles are falling off.

This is what Jesus meant when He said:

The prince of this world cometh, and hath nothing in me.

There was nothing in His life Satan could use to control Him. It was all dead. He had mortified it, put it to death.

This is what Paul means when he says it is through the Spirit that you mortify, put to death, the deeds of the body.

There was a woman who was extremely rich. Her husband was a multi-millionaire. The woman was extremely faithful to her little Pentecostal church down on the corner. If she came in after nine, he would physically and mentally abuse her to the breaking point. It did not make any difference; she remained faithful.

One day, through no foresight of his own, this multi-millionaire died and left her his entire fortune. You talk about an elated little Pentecostal church. They were elated, this multi-millionaire widow sitting on the front row.

After a while, her attendance became less and less frequent while her cars became longer and longer. She went from the front of the church to the middle, then to the back. She only attended during crusades. Eventually she dropped out of them. The only power she went out under was the gold draped on her arms when she raised her hand and went out under the weight of it.

Everybody said, "It would have been better if she had never inherited that money at all."

Wrong.

You do not climb into an attic, turn the light on, and say, "My God, look at all the dirt this light brought." The dirt was already there. All the light did was expose it.

Jesus said, "These are they which are sown among thorns." When the Word landed, the thorns already existed. The money was not her problem. All the money did was bring out of the woman what she was already capable of.

I would rather the Holy Ghost bring it out and put it to death than have wealth bring it out and let it destroy me.

You can take a man in a communist-block country, where the word communism means all things in common. Where is a man's initiative to be the best doctor on the block when all things are in common? How can you have initiative for business or to be the best schoolteacher when all things are in common? When there is no religious freedom, adversity causes the flesh to look for a way out. Pleasure causes it to look for a way in.

Yet this believer in a communist-block country will raise his hands and praise God at the risk of imprisonment, torture, and even death. Transport him into a land such as America with freedom of enterprise, and to make it interesting, give him freedom of religion and a couple hundred thousand dollars to start his new life with. His loyalty to Jesus Christ is about to be more severely tested than he ever dreamed under adversity.

When it comes to adversity, the flesh looks for a way out. When it comes to pleasure, it looks for a way in.

It is said that the Church always prospers in great times of adversity, that there is a great influx into the Church. Is there really? Because in great times of prosperity, the same people fall away.

So when is our loyalty more severely tested, in times of adversity or times of prosperity?

It was not the money. It was the love of it. That already existed inside the woman before she got the money. All the money did was bring it out.

How many of you have ceilings on your life that have kept your spiritual growth at a standstill, where one day looks like the next until one week turns into another year? After a year, you look back over your life and you have done no more. You are just as defeated because you have been ceilinged.

This is what the eighth operation is about.

Of all the operations of God, diversities of tongues is the one God designed so He could get personally involved with your spirit and supply the power you need to fill every other office and calling He separated you to. It gives you the insight, wisdom, authority, and empowerment that go with your office, whether you be helps, governments, a multimillionaire called to support the gospel, preacher, teacher, worker of miracles, gifts of healings, apostle, prophet, whatever the call.

The eighth operation is what all the rest rest upon. It is designed to turn God loose on the inside of your spirit so permanent change takes place. It is called tongues for personal edification.

So do not let that cockroach knock you out.

"I just do not feel like my prayers are getting through."

On the contrary, you are getting more done than you dream possible, more even than in free flow when you felt good and prickly and high and said, "We had a good prayer session that time."

You ought to come out when your words splat and you feel depressed and like your prayers are not getting anywhere and say, "Boy, we really had a good session tonight," because that is when you are producing.

That one is lining you up for the deep intercessional groanings that will eventually come. When they come, they will change your city.

This is what historical revivals are made out of.

I can hardly wait until tomorrow night. I want to ignite some more Word. Do you not?

"I want my business to succeed."

Then get the cockroaches out of it.

"I want my ministry to succeed."

Not as much as God does. You must be quite a problem.

I have been a victim too. He purged some things out of me that delivered me to peace. He will do it to you.

Home-meeting prophets do not like these kinds of prayer things because they take endurance and substance to life. It is time-consuming. It is developing intimate relationship with Jesus Christ. It is time-consuming. You need to dedicate nights a week, but the reward is worth it.

Home-meeting prophets do not like this kind of thing because they do not get any glory out of staying there, shutting up, praying in tongues quietly, and not causing scenes. They will go find a little group where they can prophesy over people again and get glory for it. They do not like anything that has work instead of glory tagged to it.

They will go find somewhere they can be king again, a big frog in a little pond. They will go mess your little church up.

Have you ever noticed why your life keeps circling around? You are the mighty prophet or prophetess God keeps sending to all these little prayer meetings because they need you. Yes, they need you all right. You broke them up, and the last ones ran.

Wise up. It is you, not them.

God is disciplined, and He has government in divine order.

Hallelujah.